FEATURE 11 OF 14 | PRIORITY P1 (RECOMMEND TREATING AS P0)

Monetization Plan

Priority	P1 (recommend treating as P0)
Judging criteria served	Monetization (30)
Estimated effort	Medium (~3-4 hrs, mostly thinking and writing) (rough estimate)
Depends on	None for the document; features 12-13 for paid tiers

Purpose

Monetization carries 30 of 100 marks - the second-largest category - yet your table lists it as P1. I recommend finishing a clear plan before the demo even if the app has no payment code. The judges want a credible target user, a pricing model and a sustainability story. All numbers below are proposals to validate, not market facts.

What it must do

- Define one primary target user and two secondary ones, with the reason each would pay (or who would pay for them).
- Define a free tier, a paid tier and an institutional tier with clear differences.
- Show how the product sustains itself: costs, price points, and what must be true for it to break even.
- Include a short validation plan (how you will test willingness to pay).
- Present it as one slide/page in the demo plus a section in the project report.

How it should work

- **Primary target user:** families protecting parents and first-time digital-payment users - the person who is scammed is often not the person who pays. The adult child or caregiver is the buyer.
- **Secondary users:** (1) students and job seekers facing fake-job/internship-fee scams; (2) small shopkeepers and merchants facing fake payment-confirmation and UPI collect scams.
- **Institutional customers (B2B / B2B2C):** banks, NBFCs and UPI/fintech apps (embed Scam Spotter checks to reduce fraud-support load); telecom providers; employers and colleges (staff/student awareness); senior-care organisations; NGOs and consumer-protection bodies.
- **Free tier:** rule-based message scan, explanation, highlighting, next steps, limited daily scans. Free is the awareness and distribution engine - it costs almost nothing to run because rules execute in the browser.
- **Premium (proposed Rs 99 / month or about Rs 799 / year):** AI second opinion, unlimited scans with history, URL reputation checks, multilingual analysis, screenshot OCR.
- **Family plan (proposed Rs 199 / month, up to 5 members):** shared history, 'check this for me' sharing between family members.
- **Institutional:** per-seat licence or per-1,000-scan API pricing, plus optional white-label for banks. Price after pilot conversations; do not guess a number in public.
- **Cost model:** margin per paying user = price - (AI calls per user x cost per call) - infrastructure share - payment fees. Compute this with real provider pricing before presenting; the AI call is the main variable cost, which is why AI is gated behind Premium and user-initiated.
- **Sustainability levers:** low marginal cost core; paid tier covers AI cost; B2B contracts provide stable revenue; possible awareness partnerships with banks, telecoms or public-interest programmes.

- **Honest risks:** large platforms already offer free scam warnings in messaging and calling apps; Indian consumers may resist paying for security. Answer: focus on explanation and education (differentiator), sell to institutions and families, keep a free tier.

UI / UX notes

- A simple pricing page or section with three columns (Free / Premium / For organisations).
- A 'Why free?' line: protecting more people makes the data and trust stronger.
- Locked features show a gentle upgrade prompt, never block the core safety result.

Edge cases and risks

- Never put the safety result behind a paywall; only extras (AI, history, OCR, API).
- Do not claim market size or user numbers you cannot source. If you quote any statistic, cite the source.
- Price assumptions must be labelled 'to be validated' in the presentation.

Acceptance tests

Try this	Expected result
Judge asks 'Who pays?'	You answer in 20 seconds: families and institutions
Judge asks 'What does it cost you per user?'	You can show the margin formula with a real number
Judge asks 'Why not Google/Truecaller?'	You answer with explainability + India-specific UPI/KYC focus
Validation	5-10 target-user interviews or a 20-person survey with a willingness-to-pay question

Demo tip for the judges

> One slide: target user -> tiers -> costs -> break-even. Keep prices marked as proposed.